

✦ TRAVEL GUIDE

New Jersey Custom Travel Plan

A handcrafted 4-day journey through skyline views,
historic towns, gardens, and the iconic Jersey Shore

▣ 4 Days / 3 Nights

▣ Newark ↔ Cape May

▣ Mid-Range Budget

01 Trip Overview

□ The Route

Starting in Newark/Hoboken, this plan traces a southward arc through Central Jersey's historic towns, then finishes at the shore. Mix of city energy, college-town charm, gardens, and beach relaxation — all within a single state.

□ Quick Facts

- ▶ **Best for:** First-time visitors wanting a balanced NJ experience
- ▶ **Pace:** Moderate — one main activity per half-day, flexible
- ▶ **Transport:** NJ Transit + 1 rental car day for the shore
- ▶ **Season:** May–October ideal; plan works year-round
- ▶ **Languages:** English · Spanish widely spoken
- ▶ **Timezone:** Eastern (ET/EDT)

□ Highlights at a Glance

- ▶ Manhattan skyline from the Hoboken waterfront
- ▶ Princeton University & Grounds For Sculpture
- ▶ Victorian Cape May or boardwalk Atlantic City
- ▶ World-class pizza, breweries, and farm-to-table dining
- ▶ Asbury Park music scene & Montclair art walks

02 Four-Day Itinerary

Day 01

▯ HOBOKEN · JERSEY CITY

The Skyline Arrival

▯ Skyline

▯ Walkable

▯ Pizza

Start on Washington Street for coffee and a bakery stop. Walk the Hoboken waterfront — the Manhattan skyline here is postcard-perfect. Ride the Hudson-Bergen Light Rail or take a ferry across the Hudson. Evening at Liberty State Park with the sunset behind the Statue of Liberty. Dinner: Razza for legendary pizza, or Zeppelin Hall for a lively beer garden.

Day 02

▯ PRINCETON · NEW BRUNSWICK

Ivy League & Art

▯ History

▯ Art

▯ Brewery

Morning at Princeton's campus: Nassau Hall, Palmer Square, and the Princeton University Art Museum. Lunch at a local café. Afternoon at Grounds For Sculpture — a 42-acre outdoor sculpture park. Evening in New Brunswick for breweries and Rutgers-area dining.

Day 03

▯ SHORE DAY

Coastal Escape

▯ Beach

▯ Boardwalk

▯ Seafood

Two choices: **Cape May** — Victorian architecture, clean beaches, lighthouse, boutique shopping, and quiet romance. **Atlantic City** — boardwalk energy, casinos, people-watching, and faster access from Central NJ. Both offer sunset walks and excellent seafood.

Day 04

▯ FLEXIBLE BUFFER

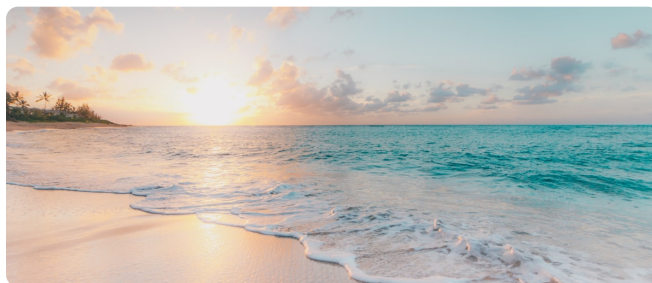
Choose Your Adventure

▯ Music

▯ Art

▯ Café

Asbury Park: iconic music history, vintage shops, the Stone Pony, and a creative boardwalk. **Montclair:** art museums, cafés, boutiques, and a calm suburban-vibe day. **Jersey City:** use it as a food-and-relaxation day before departure.



03 Accommodation & Transport



□ Where to Stay

- ▶ **Hoboken / Jersey City** — Waterfront skyline views, NYC access, lively. \$160-280/night
- ▶ **Princeton** — Quiet historic base, walkable campus area. \$140-220/night
- ▶ **Cape May** — Victorian B&Bs and inns, charming but book ahead. \$180-350/night
- ▶ **Asbury Park** — Boutique hotels near the boardwalk, mid-range. \$130-250/night

□ Getting Around

- ▶ **NJ Transit:** trains from Newark to Hoboken, Jersey City, Princeton Junction, New Brunswick. Reliable and affordable.
- ▶ **PATH:** connects Jersey City/Hoboken to Manhattan in minutes. Runs 24h on some lines.
- ▶ **Rental car:** essential for Grounds For Sculpture, Cape May, AC, Asbury Park. Reserve in advance.
- ▶ **Rideshare:** Uber/Lyft available in cities; limited in rural areas.
- ▶ **Ferry:** NYC ↔ Hoboken/Jersey City ferries are scenic but pricier.

□ Travel Times

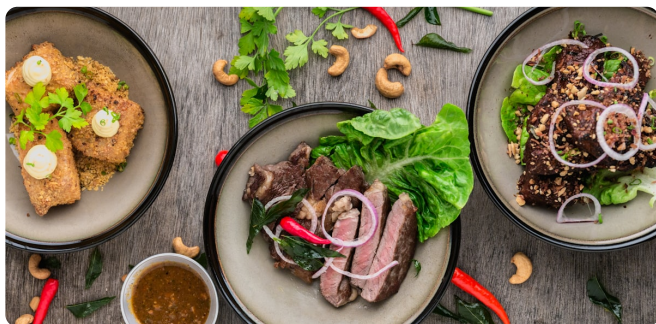
- ▶ Newark → Hoboken: 15 min by train
- ▶ Hoboken → Princeton: 50 min by NJ Transit + shuttle
- ▶ Princeton → Cape May: 2 hr drive
- ▶ Princeton → Atlantic City: 1.5 hr drive
- ▶ Newark → Jersey City: 10 min by PATH

Budget Estimate

CATEGORY	EST. COST (PER PERSON/DAY)	NOTES
□ Accommodation	\$140-\$280 / night	Varies by area and season
□ Food & Drink	\$55-\$120 / day	Mix of casual + one nice dinner

☐ Local Transit	\$15-\$35 / day	Trains, buses, rideshares
☐ Rental Car (Day 3-4)	\$70-\$140 / day	Plus parking, gas, tolls
☐ Attractions	\$0-\$60 / day	Gardens, museums, galleries
Total (per person)	\$860-\$1,820	For the full 4-day trip

04 Food, Experiences & Tips



▣ Must-Try Food

- ▣ **Pizza:** Razza (Jersey City) — often ranked among America's best
- ▣ **Seafood:** Cape May crab shack or AC boardwalk lobster roll
- ▣ **Breweries:** Triumph Brewing (Princeton), Departed Soles (Jersey City)
- ▣ ☕ **Café culture:** Hoboken's Washington Street is dense with artisanal coffee
- ▣ **Ice cream:** The bent spoon (Hoboken), Springer's (Cape May)

▣ Cultural Experiences

- ▣ **Grounds For Sculpture** — 42 acres of outdoor art in Hamilton
- ▣ **Liberty State Park** — skyline + Statue of Liberty views
- ▣ **Princeton Art Museum** — world-class collection, free entry
- ▣ **Asbury Park boardwalk** — music history, street art, vintage stores
- ▣ **Cape May Lighthouse** — climb 199 steps for panoramic views

▣ Packing Checklist

- ✓ Comfortable walking shoes (waterfront, campus, boardwalk)
- ✓ Light jacket or layer for shore evenings
- ✓ Portable charger for skyline photos & navigation
- ✓ Sunglasses & sunscreen
- ✓ Swimwear only if you're doing beach time
- ✓ Small day bag for gardens and walks

▣ Best Seasons

- ▣ **May-June:** Perfect weather, gardens in bloom, fewer crowds
- ▣ * **July-August:** Peak beach season, busier, book ahead
- ▣ **Sept-Oct:** Best for shore + fall foliage, mild days
- ▣ * **Winter:** Great for city days, indoor dining, quieter

▣ Pro Tips

- ▣ Book Cape May B&Bs at least 3–4 weeks ahead in summer
- ▣ Avoid NYC rush hours on PATH/NJ Transit (8–10am, 5–7pm)
- ▣ Leave for shore before 10am to beat traffic
- ▣ Many attractions offer student/senior discounts
- ▣ Download NJ Transit app for real-time schedules

✦ Designed with care — every recommendation tested for a genuine New Jersey experience ✦

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